SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #69 · HELL

“My loved one is in hell because I didn’t share my faith enough.”

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Where it often comes from

Grief over a loved one who died without clear faith. Teaching that placed the full weight of someone’s salvation on your witness. Regret over missed conversations. Hearing that “their blood is on your hands.” Love that wishes you could have done more.

What Scripture teaches

We are called to share our faith, and it is natural to grieve missed opportunities. But salvation is God’s work. Paul planted and Apollos watered, but God made it grow. Jesus said no one comes to Him unless the Father draws him. God does not want anyone to perish, and He is far more loving and patient than we are. You do not know all that happened between your loved one and God. The Judge of all the earth will do what is right.

> *“I planted the seed and Apollos watered it, but God made it grow. So neither he who plants nor he who waters is anything, but only God, who makes things grow”* **(1 Corinthians 3:6–7)**.

Also see

> “‘No one can come to Me unless the Father who sent Me draws him, and I will raise him up at the last day.’” **(John 6:44)**.

> “The Lord is not slow in keeping His promise as some understand slowness, but is patient with you, not wanting anyone to perish but everyone to come to repentance” **(2 Peter 3:9)**.

> “Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?” **(Genesis 18:25)**.

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” **(Romans 8:1)**.

Common self-statements

- It’s my fault they’re lost.
- If I had said more, they’d be in heaven.
- God holds me responsible for their soul.
- I failed them forever.
- I can never forgive myself for staying quiet.
- Their eternity rested on me.

Common logical errors

- **Personalization:** Taking responsibility for something only God can do.
- **Mind reading:** Assuming you know your loved one’s final relationship with God.
- **Guilt-driven thinking:** Letting regret become a verdict.
- **Magnification:** Making your role larger than God’s.

Challenging questions

- Who makes the seed grow, according to 1 Corinthians 3:6–7?
- Who draws people to Jesus, according to John 6:44?
- Do I know everything that happened between my loved one and God?
- Does God want anyone to perish?
- Can I trust the Judge of all the earth to do what is right?
- Is this guilt from God or from grief?
- How can I honor my loved one by sharing my faith with others now?

Truth summary

> My loved one's eternity did not rest on me alone. Salvation is God's work; He draws people and makes the seed grow. I don't know everything that happened between my loved one and God, but I know He is patient, loving, and just. I can grieve, bring my regrets to God, and share my faith with others out of love, not guilt.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- **Grief**
- **Witness**
- **Death/Dying**
- **Guilt/Shame**
- **Trust**

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My loved one is in hell because I didn't share my faith enough"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My loved one is in hell because I didn't share my faith enough." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who makes the seed grow?
- ☐ Who draws people to Jesus?
- ☐ Do I know everything between them and God?
- ☐ Does God want anyone to perish?
- ☐ Can I trust God to do what is right?
- ☐ Is this guilt from God or from grief?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Salvation is God's work, not mine alone.
- ☐ God draws people to Himself.
- ☐ God does not want anyone to perish.
- ☐ I don't know everything that happened between them and God.
- ☐ The Judge of all the earth will do what is right.
- ☐ I can share my faith out of love, not guilt.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 3:6–7**
  "I planted the seed and Apollos watered it, but God made it grow. So neither he who plants nor he who waters is anything, but only God, who makes things grow."
- [ ] **John 6:44**
  "'No one can come to Me unless the Father who sent Me draws him, and I will raise him up at the last day.'"
- [ ] **2 Peter 3:9**
  "The Lord is not slow in keeping His promise as some understand slowness, but is patient with you, not wanting anyone to perish but everyone to come to repentance."
- [ ] **Genesis 18:25**
  "Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?"
- [ ] **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Grief and trust journal:** Each day, write one memory of my loved one and one sentence trusting them to God.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for **Sarah**, who is in Christ Jesus."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write a letter to God** about your regrets and your love for this person, and give it to Him.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 3:5–9,** and write who does what in bringing people to faith.
- ☐ **Share your faith gently with one person** this month, as an act of love, not guilt.
- ☐ **Talk with a grief counselor or pastor** about your loss and regret.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My loved one is in hell because I didn't share my faith enough": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One time I trusted my loved one to God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My loved one is in hell because I didn't share my faith enough.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I grieve for the person I love and wish I had done more. Help me reject the lie that their eternity rested on me alone. Thank You that salvation is Your work and that You are patient, loving, and just. I trust them to You, and I ask You to help me share Your love with others. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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